



640,000 firms register for UAE corporate tax

HIGH VOLUME OF TAX RETURNS SHOWS GROWING BUSINESS AWARENESS: FTA

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The Federal Tax Authority (FTA) has announced record levels of corporate tax compliance, with more than 640,000 businesses registered and a strong turnout in filing returns and settling dues within legal deadlines.

The FTA said this reflects the efficiency of the UAE's tax legislation and digital systems, which align with international best practices and support businesses through streamlined electronic procedures.

The Authority expressed appreciation to corporate taxpayers for achieving compliance rates exceeding global benchmarks, noting that the first round of filings — covering financial years ending December 31, 2024 — was completed successfully by the end of September 2025.

Khalid Ali Al Bustani, Director General of the Federal Tax Authority, said: "Statistics show that hundreds of thousands of Corporate Tax returns and annual declarations have been processed from registrants whose tax period or financial year ended on December 31, 2024."

"This high level of tax compliance has been achieved as a result of the growing tax awareness among business sectors, and due to the ease of steps provided by the Authority for filing returns and settling due taxes through the 'EmaraTax' platform, which delivers round-the-clock digital tax services distinguished by clarity and efficiency."

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Khalid Ali Al Bustani
Director General of the
Federal Tax Authority

He added that thousands of requests were handled daily during peak filing periods, with support provided through the FTA Call Centre.

Flexible environment

Al Bustani said the UAE's leadership has ensured a flexible and encouraging tax environment, introducing measures to support voluntary compliance.

"In line with the UAE leadership's wisdom in implementing directives to maintain a tax legislative environment that encourages voluntary compliance and adapts flexibly to changes, several initiatives were launched to support Corporate Taxpayers and facilitate compliance," he said.

These include a Cabinet Decision exempting corporate taxpayers and certain entities from administrative penalties for late registration, provided they file returns within seven months of their first tax period.



Demonstrators gather at Museumplein in Amsterdam yesterday demanding "government action to stop the genocide in Gaza". Hundreds of thousands marched in solidarity with Palestinians across Europe and the Middle East yesterday.

Israeli bombing must stop for Gaza hostage release, US says

Arab and Muslim nations welcome Hamas' response

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

The US has said Israel must stop bombing Gaza to allow the release of hostages held by Hamas, as diplomatic efforts gathered pace yesterday to implement President Donald Trump's new Gaza peace plan, raising the strongest hopes yet for an end to nearly two years of war.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, appearing on several Sunday talk shows, said that continued airstrikes were incompatible with the release process.

"I think the Israelis and everyone acknowledge you can't release hostages in the middle of strikes, so the strikes will have to stop," Rubio told CBS

News. "There can't be a war going on in the middle of it."

His remarks followed another night of Israeli attacks that killed at least 19 Palestinians.

Arab and Muslim nations yesterday welcomed Hamas's response to the peace proposal.

A joint statement from the foreign ministers of the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Jordan, the UAE, Qatar, Egypt, Indonesia, Turkey and Pakistan came after Hamas showed a positive response to Trump's proposal.

Trump's proposal

The statement highlighted that the foreign ministers "welcomed the steps taken by Hamas regarding ... Trump's proposal to end the war on Gaza, release all hostages, whether alive or deceased, and the immediate launch of negotiations on the implementation mechanism."

Trump's proposal requires Hamas to return all hostages

within 72 hours of Israel's public acceptance of the deal. In return, Israel would release nearly 2,000 Palestinian prisoners and gradually pull back forces from Gaza once an international security force takes over.

Talks in Cairo

Trump said Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was "on board" with ending the military campaign and accepted the first phase of the plan. But he warned that if Hamas refused to cede power and disarm, it would face "complete obliteration."

Negotiators were converging on Cairo yesterday ahead of crucial indirect talks mediated by Egypt, Qatar, and the US. Officials confirmed delegations from both Israel and Hamas would discuss the exchange of hostages and Palestinian prisoners, as well as the conditions for a sustained ceasefire.

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Dubai grants golden visas to more than 200 educators

World Teachers' Day initiative honours contributions to learning and society

DUBAI
BY NATHANIEL LACSINA
Senior Web Editor

Over 200 outstanding educators from early childhood centres, schools, and universities across the emirate have been granted golden visas following a directive by Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, UAE's Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

The initiative, first announced on World Teachers' Day 2024, honours educators who have made exceptional contributions to learning and society. "Teachers and educators light the way forward. They inspire, guide, and equip our children with the skills to succeed," Shaikh Hamdan said.

"On World Teachers' Day, we reaffirm that supporting them is one of the best investments in Dubai's future."

By awarding golden visas, Shaikh Hamdan added, Dubai is recognising the values of knowledge, integrity, and service, while ensuring schools remain places where the next generation can thrive.

In the first round, 435 applications were received, of which 223 educators were selected. Evaluations were based on qualifications, achievements, contributions to education and society, and feedback from students and parents. Demographic factors such as nationality, gender, or years of experience were excluded to ensure fairness.

Of the school awarded, 157 went to school staff, 60 to university faculty, and six to early childhood centre educators. Candidates included senior leaders, teachers, social workers, and librarians. Special recognition was given to award winners, published researchers, and those with notable community impact.

Applications for the second round of golden visas will open from October 15 to December 15 for educators in private early childhood centres, schools, and international higher education institutions in Dubai.

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